

with your audience. As your goal is to communicate your message to as many people as possible, using difficult terminology and industry buzzwords without a detailed explanation can cause an undesirable level of frustration at your Web site.

Strive for clean and simple language, easily understandable by anyone who might examine your Web content. Consider a glossary or terminology page if you are using terms not part of normal discourse. It also is a good idea to write out the full meaning of an acronym the first time it is used (and identify the acronym itself parenthetically).

Strive for User-Friendly Navigation

Because visitors to your Web site might not be navigating through the traditional browser interface, it is very important to produce a clear navigational structure for your Web site. Options such as a simple text menu bar can help someone on the most primitive browser easily find their way through your site easily.

When creating a hyperlink, use text that is descriptive. For example, the phrase “Click here” or other non-descriptive text is not as helpful to the user as “Go to the Microsoft home page.”

Strive for a clear, consistently positioned navigational structure for your site. Not only does it make the site accessible, but it also is excellent practice for all levels of Web design.

Be Cautious When Working With Frames

In many ways, the best approach in the development of an accessible Web site is to stay away from frames. Frames pages can create problems for any non-traditional browser. Trying to convey the concept of a frame through a reader is extremely difficult.

Provide Descriptive Text for Frames

Accessible Web content can include frames. However, the frames must have descriptive text so that users with browsers that do not support frames can access them. As an alternative to frames, you